

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Benchmarks for engineering managers and HR leaders

65,437

respondents

180+

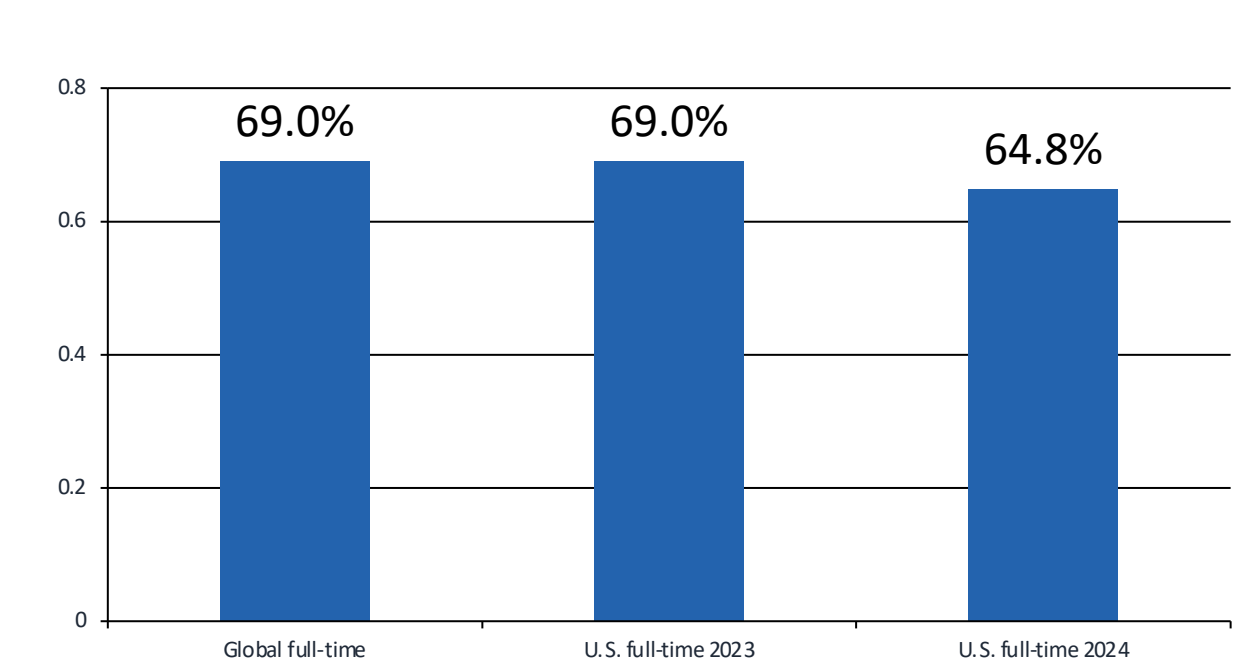
countries

84%

currently working

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Global employment mix and U.S. full-time change

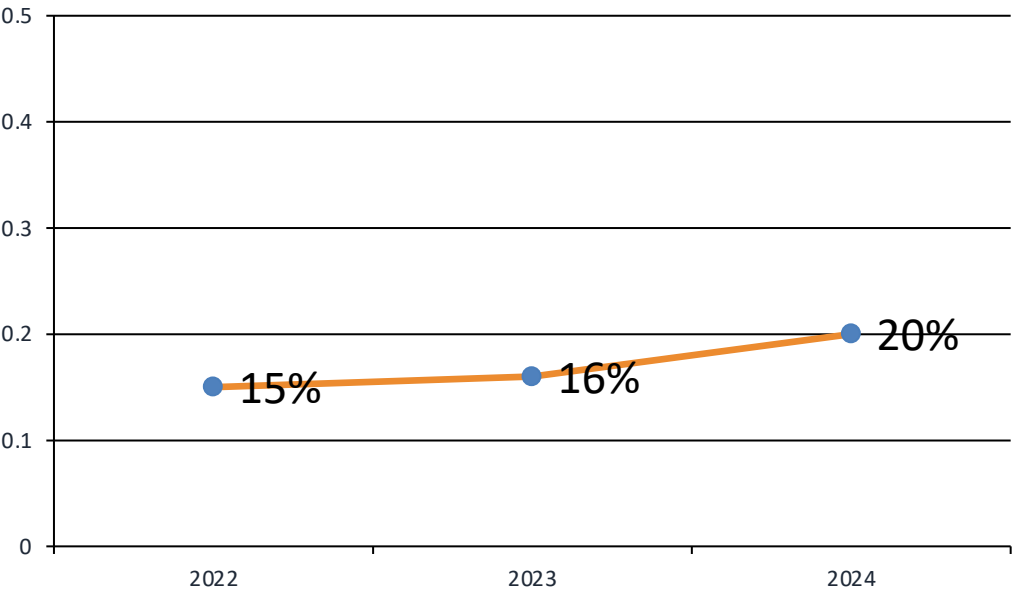


- Full-time employment remains the dominant global mode at 69%.
- Independent contracting/freelancing is significant at 16.4%.
- In the U.S., full-time employment fell from 69% in 2023 to 64.8% in 2024.
- Non-full-time patterns vary by market: contracting in the U.K. and Ukraine; students

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

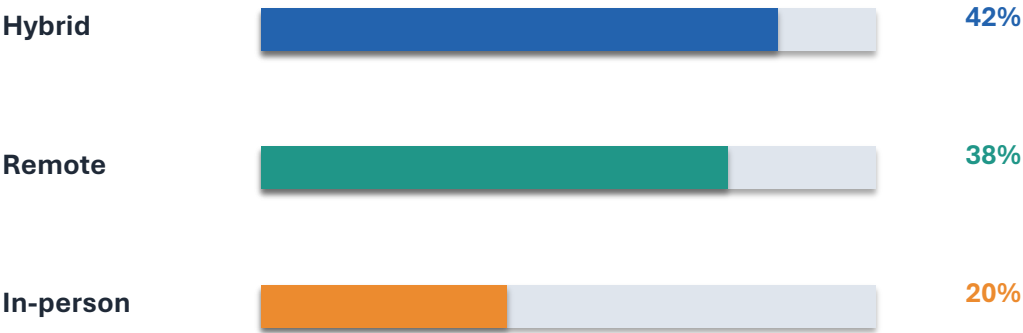
Work environment signals a gradual return-to-office trend

In-person trend



In-person work rose for the third consecutive year: 15% → 16% → 20%.

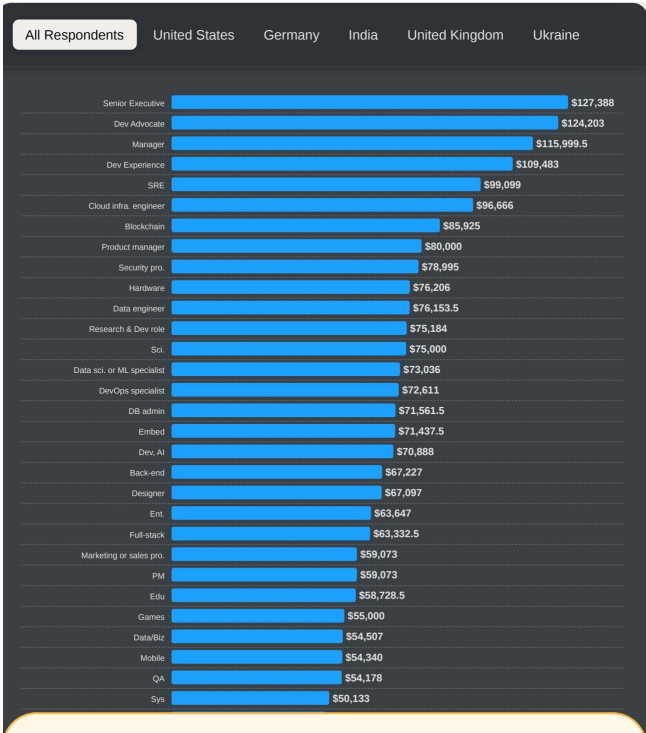
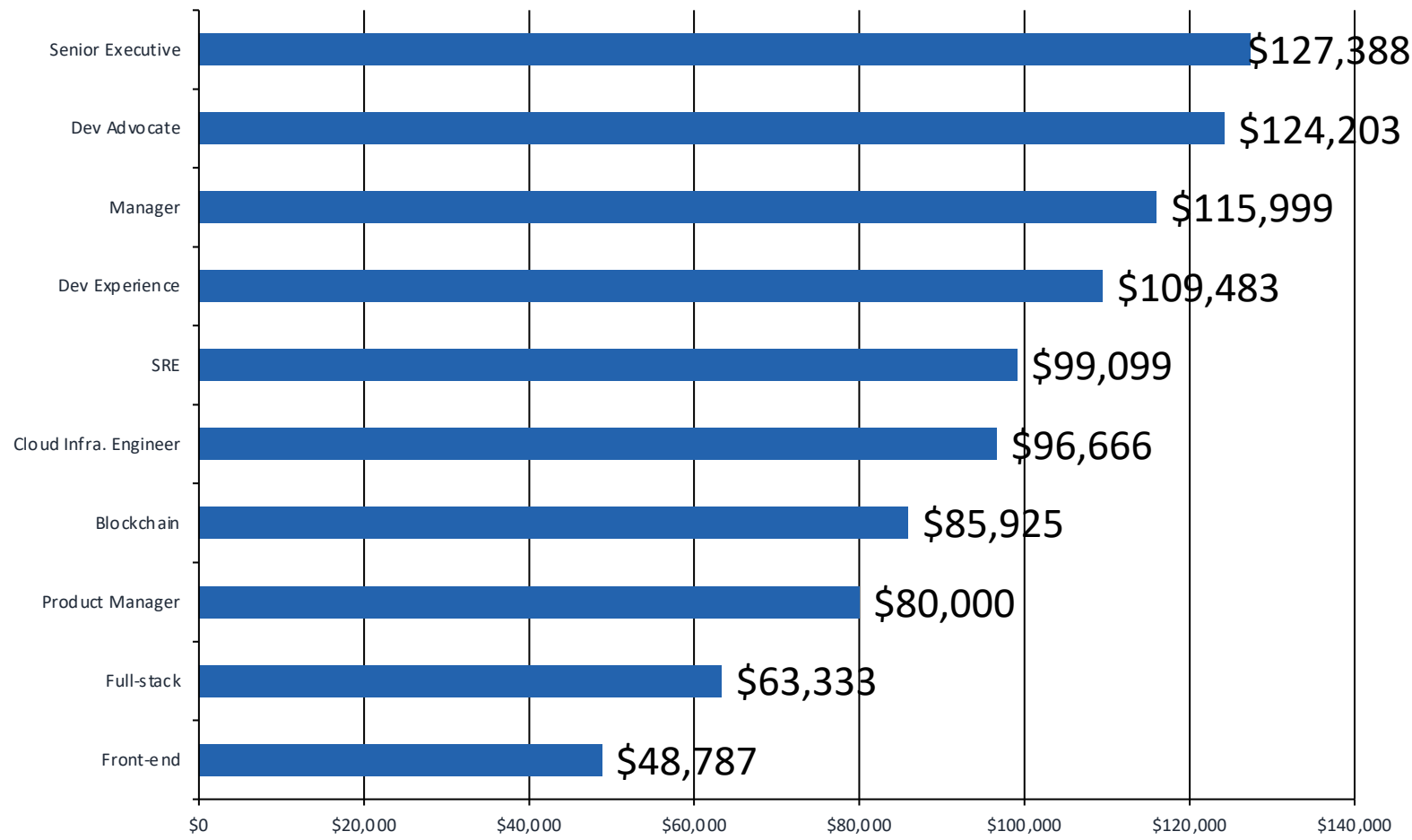
2024 work environment mix



Hybrid remains the most common arrangement at 42%, consistent with 2023; remote accounts for 38%.

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

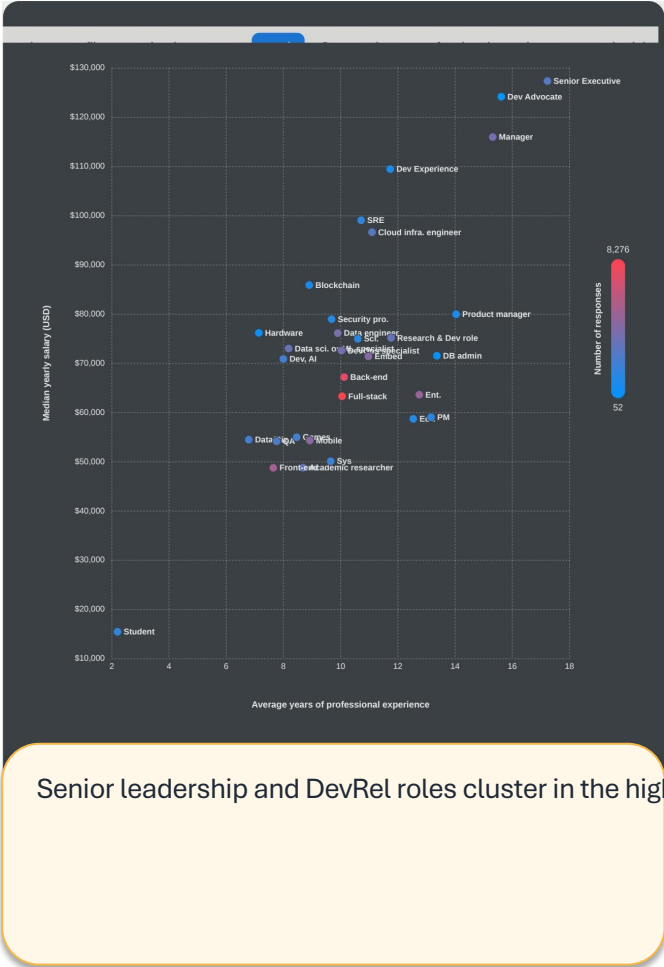
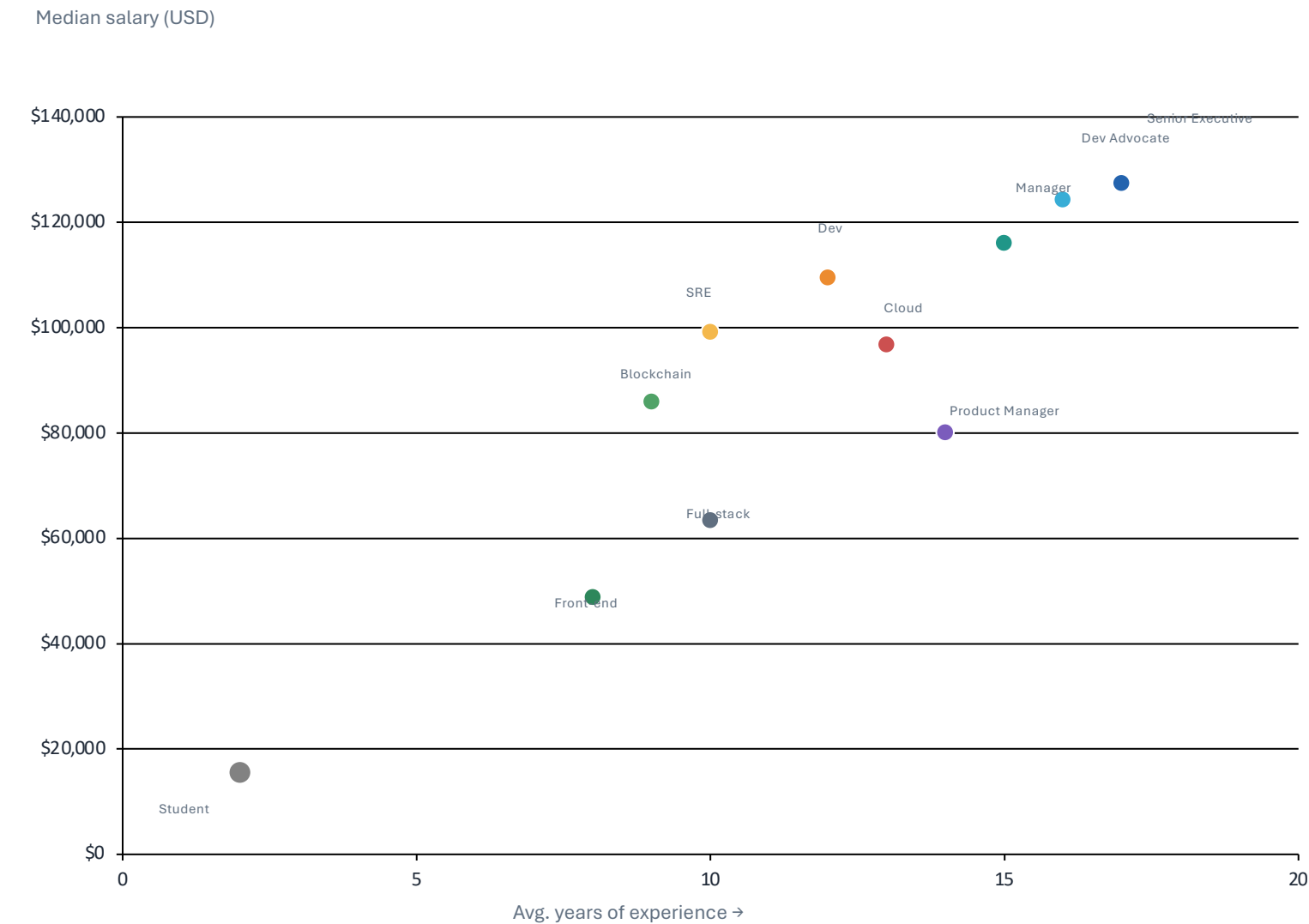
Median annual compensation by developer type; top 10 roles shown



22,677 salary responses; 34.7% response rate. SRE and cloud

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

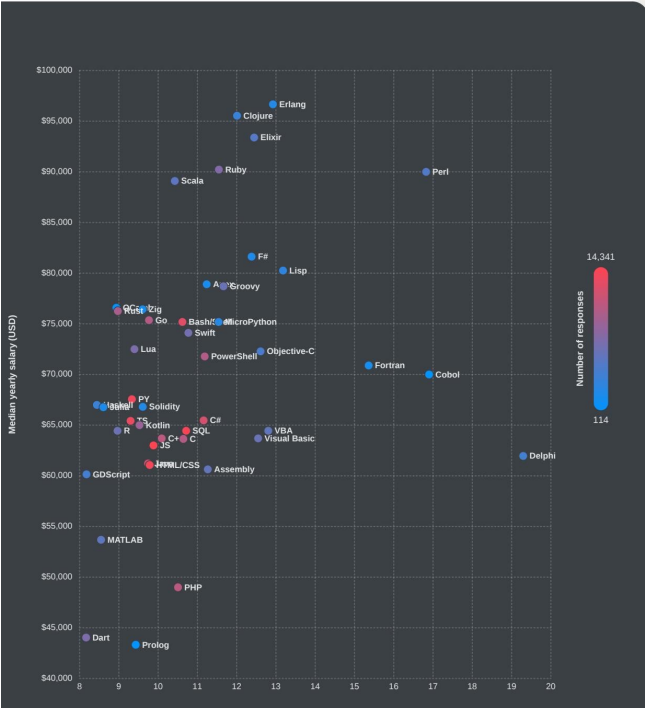
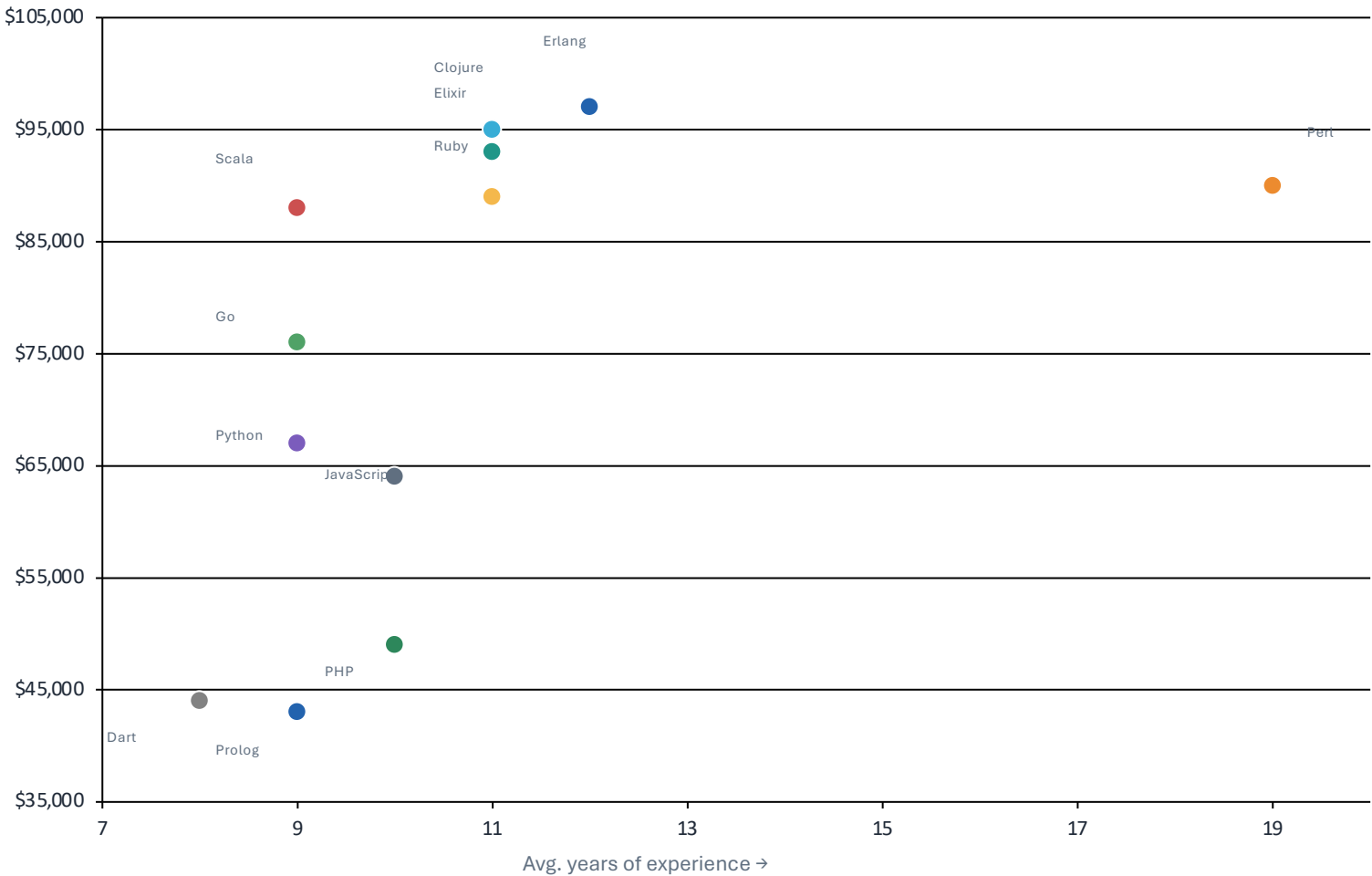
Median salary vs. average years of experience by developer type



Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Median salary vs. experience by programming language

Median salary (USD)

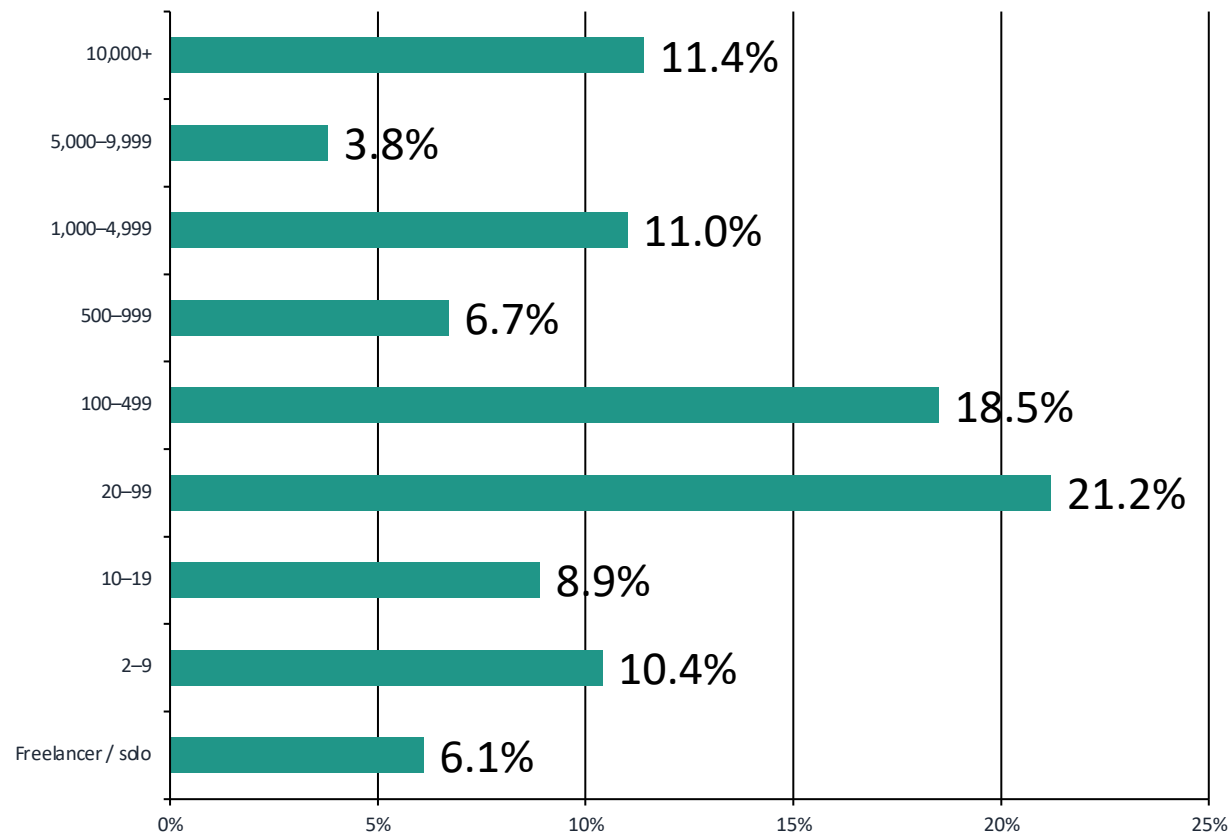


Niche functional languages lead: Erlang ~\$97K, Clojure ~\$95K, E

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company-size context and developer buying influence

Company-size distribution (42,827 respondents)



47%

work at organizations with fewer than 100 employees

62%

influence technology purchases

60%

prefer a build-and-buy approach

Top purchase influencers

Senior executives 99% | Engineering managers 87% | Product managers 77%

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

Actionable benchmarks for compensation planning and workforce strategy

1

Plan for more flexible talent models

Full-time employment is softening in the U.S.; freelancing and contracting remain above 16% globally.

2

Anchor policies around hybrid first

In-person work is rising, but hybrid remains the dominant arrangement at 42%.

3

Budget premium pay for scarce roles

DevRel, SRE, cloud infrastructure, and leadership roles command the strongest medians.

4

Use language benchmarks carefully

Niche functional languages correlate with higher pay; mainstream languages sit lower in the provided benchmarks.

5

Engage developers as buyers

62% influence purchases, so tool evaluation and vendor outreach should include individual contributors.

Use the survey as directional benchmarking: pair compensation bands with role scarcity, experience expectations, work model, and market-specific hiring patterns.